rooms, which was nice – more a suite vibe, with an open-plan design that included a lounge and two single beds. All in all, too much for one man. A quick phone call later and one of my single colleagues was knocking on my room door in what I can only describe as an enthusiastic manner.

Two beds, two cricketers and three women. One of them wasn't all that keen though; she just lay on the bed. Which was fine – there was enough for everyone. The other two girls, however, more than made a go of it. I got the ball rolling, but then I noticed that my mate was feeling a little left out. Now he's lying on the other bed, so, big-hearted chap that I am, I say, 'Well, you can't leave my mate all alone there.' And fortunately one of them was only too happy to transfer ship.

And that wasn't the only time my teammates and I were doubleteamed by a couple of eager young Aussie lasses. During the third Test in Sydney on that 1998 tour, a teammate and I spotted two girls sitting next to the players' viewing area. Unbeknown to us, the two of them had a reputation: they were determined to make their way through the cricketing nations of the world, if you know what I mean.

My teammate invited them back to his room – we always seemed to end up in this guy's room, for some reason – though I wasn't there initially. As I was playing the next day, I was planning an early night. Next thing – it could not have been much after 10 p.m. – I get a call from my teammate: 'No, Hersch, we've got these two chicks here, but fuck, nothing wants to happen.'

So I said, 'Give me the phone. Let me speak to one of them.' So I spoke to this chick and said, 'Listen, now what's the bladdy story? Everybody is up for it, but no one wants to make the first move? Just hang on, I'm coming down.'

Anyway, so I put on my bathrobe, take the lift, go to the room, and there are the lads. And these two hotties. I seemed to be the missing ingredient in the cocktail, and with a few sweetly whispered words, it wasn't long before proceedings got under way. Without going into too much detail, let's just say that the evening came to a very enjoyable conclusion.

It certainly was one helluva trip. But that's Australian women for you. They were just always up for it. I remember a South African bowler coming back from the first World Cup this country ever played in 1992 and telling me the guys had had an absolute bladdy whale of a time with the Aussie women. During that World Cup, the Proteas had played good cricket to get